

DO YOU REALLY OWN YOUR PHONE?

The smartphone business relies on convincing consumers to dump their not-so-old devices, broken or not, for the latest offerings. This only fuels this consumerist pattern we've fallen into. Read Ugo Vallauri's insight to change your mindset about considering electronic devices disposable. <http://dgit.in/wwphph>

SPACEX - THE FUTURE OF NET COMMUNICATION

Elon Musk's commercial space company, SpaceX just launched a Falcon 9 into orbit carrying the CSA satellite, CASSIOPE. The satellite's payload includes Cascade, a prototype for a super-fast space-borne file-transfer system – a digital courier service. <http://dgit.in/wwbum>

THE 9 LEAST COMPETENT JEDI

Masters of the Force and capable of mind tricks it seems the weren't very bright. From Qui-Gon Jinn to Obi-Wan Kenobi, this articles details the mind-numbing stupidity some Jedi display. Stay back at the Academy, some should. <http://dgit.in/wwdumbj>

STORY OF AN INTERNET CRIMINAL MASTERMIND

This is the story of 29 year old American named Ross Ulbricht who operated a billion dollar illegal empire out of a San Francisco coffee shop. What was his crime? He sold drugs like heroin, cocaine, meth, molly, and LSD through the dark web. Here's how he did it: <http://dgit.in/drglord>

Google, put down that Kit-Kat

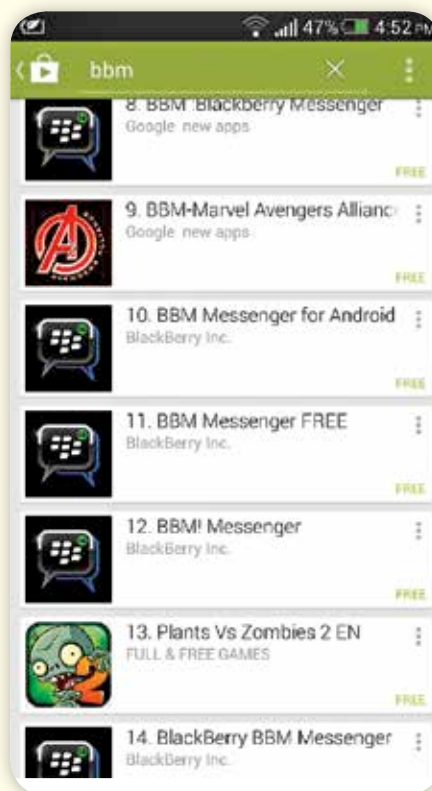
The Play Store is a mess, uncurated mess of apps, many of which have no right to be there. Kids especially can get into a lot of trouble if they're not careful. Here's why.

- By Vishal Mathur

After the BBM app leak on Android store last month, it was inevitable that BlackBerry would face a backlash for not doing things properly and many "experts" quickly followed up with the "I told you so, routine". However, no one really bothered to go into what really was the root cause of the issue. I am sad about this too, but please allow me to burst the bubble – the real cause of this problem was Android. Specifically the Play Store.

While the entire episode with BBM for Android was unfolding, one thing that got highlighted was the amount of fake apps on the Play Store. Most Android users would assume that the apps on the Play Store would be fine to download, all tested and approved by the organization that many assume as the saviour of the earth - Google. However, most of us who are in this line of work know that isn't the case. A simple search for BBM on the Play Store, on the actual launch date, revealed a bunch of fake apps. Most had the listing icon as the actual BBM icon, which would seem genuine to almost any unsuspecting user. Adding the cherry on top of this poisonous cake was the fact that the developers were listed as BlackBerry Inc. and Google new apps. The horrors don't stop there, if you actually open the app page, you'll see screenshots from what is possibly the beta version of BBM.

This discovery led to another discovery - the Play Store is teeming with apps that you wouldn't want your child to see or use. It looks like there is no control over what



goes live on the Play Store, and some of those insensitive apps might even make it to the Trending apps list! Imagine what would happen if your kid navigates to the Play Store in search of a game? He's not going to find what he wants and will probably be inundated by fakes anyway.

This does make us wonder - will Google ever clean up the Play Store? It has always claimed the moral high ground by being an

"open" platform to Apple's so-called "closed" platform. But, since it's never a good idea to vote for censorship regarding content, the simpler way would be for Google to make it easier for parents to change the content restrictions on the device. At the moment, they are there buried deep inside the settings menu, but surely most first time Android users cannot be expected to figure them out.

Personally, in this battle, I believe Windows Phone has the best model for the other stores to follow. Of course, the Windows Phone Marketplace is not really teeming with apps the way the Play Store and App store are, it's still implemented a better approval system that ensures that the apps that are put up are what they claim to be. An advantage of arriving late to the game we suppose.

We don't really want to get into an argument regarding the merits (or demerits) of any particular application store. What we are trying to say however is that free stuff is always nice, but there needs to be a system of checks and balances somewhere in the system. Companies need to be more responsible for the services they provide and they need to get serious about it.

While some may argue that Microsoft has the luxury of indulging in this "censorship" due to the limited number of apps they probably receive in the first place, one must remember that companies like Google are more than well-equipped to handle this situation. They just need to decide to do it.